UCLA Extension

398501: Leadership and the Human Element in Project Management

MGMT-X 443.4

Summer 2024 Section 1 4 Credits 06/24/2024 to 09/08/2024 Modified 05/21/2024

Meeting Times

Online

This course takes place fully online and includes optional live meetings through the Canvas Zoom feature.

Zoom meetings will be held on Mondays at 6:45 pm Pacific Time (US). These meetings are an open Office Hour time to supplement our course content where you can ask questions, get clarification on material or coursework, have real time discussion, and a chance to delve deeper into the subject matter. All Zoom meetings will be recorded, and attendance is optional but highly encouraged.

Course weeks run from Monday at 12:00 am to Sunday at 11:59 pm Pacific Time (US).

Week 1 - June 24, 2024

Week 2 - July 1, 2024

Week 3 - July 8, 2024

Week 4 - July 15, 2024

Week 5 - July 22, 2024

Week 6 - July 29, 2024

Week 7 - August 5, 2024

Week 8 - August 12, 2024

Week 9 - August 19, 2024

Week 10 - August 26, 2024

Week 11 - September 2, 2024

NOTE FOR STUDENTS

How long will I have access to this course in Canvas?

"This course will remain accessible for 30 days after the course end date listed at the top of your course syllabus."

Further Details:

- The first 14 days are full-access. You will be able to download all course material.
- The remaining 16 days are read-only. You will NOT be able to download course materials including your own submitted work.
- After 30 days, no access.

Contact Information

Instructor: Margaret Meloni

Email: mmeloni@g.ucla.edu
Phone: 562 760-6392

You may also contact me through the Canvas Inbox. (https://community.canvaslms.com/docs/DOC-10573-4212710324)

UCLA Extension Department Contact:

Email: ET@uclaextension.edu
Phone: (310) 825-4100

Description

Effective leadership skills are perhaps the greatest determinant of project success. Project managers must demonstrate leadership effectiveness throughout each phase of the project life cycle. Review and recognize specific leadership styles in the context of real-world examples. Participative assignments help both current and future project managers enhance their own leadership effectiveness. Course content covers project communication, motivation, conflict resolution, negotiation, stress management and effective leadership in the context of project management. Participants identify the leadership challenges unique to the project environment, identify their leadership strengths and weaknesses, identify five conflict resolution modes and when to use them, and learn to differentiate between position power and personal power. Note: This course is NOT interchangeable with MGMT X 490.996 Leadership Communication Strategies.

Objectives

Students will gain an understanding of the leadership skills required to lead a project team to successfully meet project objectives.

Students will learn about key leadership skills and then consider how best to improve their skills.

Students will integrate lessons on how to lead, resulting in each student creating his or her own definition of how he or she will lead.

Outcomes

Upon course completion students will:

- Identify the leadership challenges of the project environment
- Define organizational culture and why it matters
- Identify their own leadership strengths and weaknesses
- Differentiate between effective and ineffective types of project communications
- List three motivational theories and discuss their key elements
- Identify five conflict resolution modes and when to use them
- Be able to select negotiating strategies that fit the situation
- Evaluate leadership styles to determine which style is effective and when
- Describe emotional intelligence and how it impacts career success
- List the effects of stress on project team members
- Describe ethical behavior
- List five types of power
- Differentiate between position power and personal power

Materials

Textbook

There is no required textbook for this class. Lectures are provided within each topic module.

Each week your instructor will provide you with readings, audios or videos to provide additional insight into our topics.

Class Structure

This course is based on the exchange of information and ideas. There will be introduction of topics and ideas, followed by discussions, and scenarios and interactive discussions and exercises.

Each week's assignments include:

- a lecture about the topic including suggestions for further topic exploration
- interactive discussion/exercises/scenarios related to that topic

- supplemental readings/audios or videos

In addition, we will have some special assignments such as:

- a short paper on an organization and it's culture
- midterm exam
- a short paper on an individual leader
- final exam

Class Environment

We all learn from each other, so please don't hesitate to ask questions or expand on the topics. My goal as an instructor is to have you accomplish all the course objectives.

Deliverables

Discussion participation, and weekly materials, exams, group presentations

You'll demonstrate that you've accomplished the course objectives in these ways:

1. Participate in weekly discussions, integrating our course materials, as seen through your eyes. Interact with at least one other classmate for full points.
2. Create an interesting and thought-provoking short paper about the culture at the organization of your choice. Teach us about the culture, and what type of behavior and leadership that you think is encouraged by the culture. Do you see this as a positive or negative culture, do you think it is sustainable? Is it working - meaning, is it helping the organization meet goals and objectives?
3. Pass the midterm and final exams. Each covers assigned reading and materials presented in class.
4. Create a short paper on the leader of your choice. Describing some of the specific leaders motivational style, communication style, conflict resolution style and other characteristics. You will then make a case - is (or was) this leader effective? Why or why not? What lessons learned has this leader taught us?

Evaluation

Criteria

Points are earned for posted work. The total number of points you earn during the class determines your course grade. There's a maximum possible total of 100 points.

Short paper on organizational culture	20 points	20%
Weekly discussions	20 points	20%

Midterm	20 points	20%
Short paper on a specific leader	20 points	20%
Final	20 points	20%
Total	100 points	100%

Work posted within the inclusive dates of the class week when the topic was assigned is eligible to receive the maximum possible number of points. The inclusive dates of our class weeks are shown in the Schedule section later in this syllabus. Make up work will be accepted with the understanding that work posted after the class week when the topic was assigned is unlikely to earn as many points as would have been granted if the work had been posted during that class week.

Breakdown

A+	100 %	to 97.0%
A	< 97.0 %	to 93.0%
A-	< 93.0 %	to 90.0%
B+	< 90.0 %	to 87.0%
B	< 87.0 %	to 83.0%
B-	< 83.0 %	to 80.0%
C+	< 80.0 %	to 77.0%
C	< 77.0 %	to 73.0%
F	< 73.0 %	to 0.0%

✱ Course Policies

Instructor Expectations

Please join this course with an open mind and be prepared to be introspective. This is for YOU. An opportunity to consider what it means to be a leader, and an opportunity for you to decide who you will be as a leader.

I am here to facilitate your experience. I respond to your emails within 24 hours. I am in our online classroom approximately four days each week. (Some weeks five days.) Typically these days include: Monday, Tuesday, Thursday, Friday, and possibly either Saturday or Sunday.

In terms of grading your work, if you turn your work in on time, you can expect the following from me:

- Discussions will be graded by Tuesday of the following week. For example, week 4 discussions posted on time will be graded by Tuesday of week 5.
- The midterm grades automatically after you submit it.
- The final grades automatically after you submit it.
- Organizational Culture paper and Leadership Essay - I grade a few papers per day in the week after they are submitted. All on time submissions will be graded by the end of day on the Friday after the due date.
- Final course grades - Posted within one week after the course end date.

People participate in this class for all sorts of reasons, but if your reason for enrolling is to learn something new and receive a high course grade, you'll need to keep up with the work.

Requirements for Assignments

In this course you will participate in discussions, complete a midterm and final exam, and write two short papers.

Discussions

Posts need to be informative and worded respectfully. Because this is a business course, please use real words in your posts as though you were writing them at work. If you include work that's not your own original work, include an attribution. A thoughtfully worded post responds to the specific topic and is between 50 to 250 words. Replies to your classmates go beyond, "Yes," or "I agree." A thoughtfully worded response is at least two to three sentences in length and elaborates on the discussion thread, or asks insightful questions.

Discussions are to be completed each week, and your participation is due at the end of each week. The end of the week is designated as Sunday at 11:59 pm pacific.

Midterm

The midterm will occur in the sixth week of class. It will cover the topics from weeks one thru five. Specifically the videos and readings. The exam is worth 20 points. It is 20 questions. The format is multiple choice. You may take it two times, your higher score will be used in calculating your overall course grade.It is due at the end of sixth week of class.

The end of the week is designated as Sunday at 11:59 pm pacific.

Final

The midterm will occur in final week of class. This is week eleven. It will cover the topics from weeks six thru ten. Specifically the videos and readings. The exam is worth 20 points. It is 20 questions. The format is multiple choice. You may take it two times, your higher score will be used in calculating your overall course grade.It is due at the end of eleventh week of class.

The end of the week is designated as Sunday at 11:59 pm pacific.

Organizational Culture Paper

Write an interesting and thought-provoking presentation about the culture of the organization of your choice. Teach your reader about the culture, and what type of behavior and leadership you think is encouraged by the culture. Do you see this as a positive or negative culture, do you think it is sustainable? Is it working - meaning, is it helping the organization meet goals and objectives?

Short paper means between 750 - 1500 words.

This paper is due at the end of the fourth week of class.

The end of the week is designated as Sunday at 11:59 pm pacific.

Leadership Essay

Write about the leader of your choice. Describe some of the specific leader's motivational style, communication style, conflict resolution style, and other characteristics. You will then make a case - is (or was) this leader effective? Why or why not? What lessons learned has this leader taught us?

Short paper means between 750 to 1500 words.

This paper is due at the end of the eleventh and final week of class.

The end of the week is designated as Sunday at 11:59 pm pacific.

Make up work and Late Assignments

Work will be accepted any time while the course is running with the understanding that you're unlikely to earn as many points for make up work as you would have had the work been posted during the class week when the topic was assigned.

The above policy applies to all course work - discussions, midterm, final, and papers.

Extensions and Extra Credit

The course is available 24 hours a day for 11 weeks. Please use your time wisely.

There is one extra credit assignment that is available, and can be found after our final course module. If you opt to complete this assignment it is worth up to 5 points, and is due on or before 11:59 pm pacific, on the last day of this course.

Course extensions will be considered on a case-by-case basis.

Planning Your Study Time

What you get out of this class depends in large part on how much effort and time you're willing to put into it. Because our class discussions are such an important part of the class, posting your answers to the week's discussion questions, asking questions or commenting on what your class colleagues have posted or posting articles that can broaden and deepen our understanding of the topic tend to be more valuable to the class if they're posted earlier in the class week. Participation in the class discussion on more than one day during the class week when the topic was assigned is strongly recommended and is rewarded by earning a weekly participation point.

🏛 Institutional Policies

Student Conduct

Students are subject to disciplinary action for several types of misconduct or attempted misconduct, including but not limited to academic dishonesty, such as cheating, multiple submission, plagiarism, or knowingly furnishing false information to the University; or behavioral misconduct, such as theft or misuse of the intellectual property of others, harassment, or disruption of the learning environment.

All published and unpublished material, whether in manuscript, printed or electronic form, is covered under this definition and includes the use of material generated wholly or in part through the use of artificial intelligence (except when the use of AI has received prior authorization for assessment as a reasonable accommodation for a student's disability, or when the use of AI is a specified part of the coursework, e.g. data science or user experience). Students are encouraged to familiarize themselves with the Student Rights & Responsibilities Policy (https://www.uclaextension.edu/student-services/rights-and-responsibilities) and to report concerns.

Services for Students with Disabilities

In accordance with the Americans with Disabilities Act of 1990, UCLA Extension provides appropriate accommodations and support services to qualified applicants and students with disabilities. These include, but are not limited to, auxiliary aids/services such as sign language interpreters, assistive listening devices for hearing-impaired individuals, extended time for and proctoring of exams, and registration assistance. Accommodations and types of support services vary and are specifically designed to meet the disability-related needs of each student based on current, verifiable medical documentation. Arrangements for auxiliary aids/services are available only through UCLA Extension's Service for Students with Disabilities Office at (310) 825-7851 or by email at ODS@uclaextension.edu. For complete information, please visit Accessibility and Disability Services (https://www.uclaextension.edu/enrollment-and-support/accessibility-and-disability-services).

Incompletes

The interim grade Incomplete (I) may be approved for a student who has completed the majority of the course requirements, with passing quality (grade C or higher), but is unable to complete a small portion of the coursework by the course end date for good cause. For courses in which an Incomplete may be allowed, approval by the instructor of record and the academic program director is required. The Incomplete grade is not an option for courses that do not bear credit, such as 700, 800, or 900-level courses.

- It is the student's responsibility to petition for an Incomplete by emailing the appropriate academic program department (https://www.uclaextension.edu/contact-ucla-extension) at least one week before the end of the course. The Program Department will initiate the petition process once the email is received.
- The student, the instructor, the CE/Program Director, and the program staff must complete the petition prior to the final course meeting or before the quarter end date (https://www.uclaextension.edu/calendar). This process can take up to one week to complete.
- The instructor will approve or deny the request. The instructor will provide details on what the student needs to accomplish in order to complete the course, as well as a due date for submitting completed work. The due date cannot exceed the end of the ensuing quarter (https://www.uclaextension.edu/calendar) when a final grade must be reported or the Incomplete lapses to the grade "F," "NP," or "U." Visit UCLA Extension Grading Scale (https://www.uclaextension.edu/transcripts-credits-grades/grading-scale) for more information.

An Incomplete allows the student to complete only work that is outstanding and does not allow prior completed work to be retaken or resubmitted.

All Grades are Final

No change of grade may be made by anyone other than the instructor, and then, only to correct clerical errors. No term grade except Incomplete may be revised by re-examination. The correction of a clerical error may be authorized only by the instructor of record communicating directly with personnel of Student and Alumni Services.

Sexual Harassment

The University of California is committed to creating and maintaining a community where all individuals who participate in University programs and activities can work and learn together in an atmosphere free of harassment, exploitation, or intimidation. Every member of the community should be aware that the University prohibits sexual harassment and sexual violence, and that such behavior violates both law and University policy. The University will respond promptly and effectively to reports of sexual harassment and sexual violence, and will take appropriate action to prevent, to correct, and when necessary, to discipline behavior that violates our policy.

All Extension students and instructors who believe they have been sexually harassed are encouraged to contact the Department of Student and Alumni Services for complaint resolution: UCLA Extension, 1145 Gayley Ave., Los Angeles, CA 90024; Voice/TTY: (310) 825-7031. For more information, please view the University's full Policy on Sexual Harassment and Sexual Violence (https://policy.ucop.edu/doc/4000385/SVSH).

Additional Items

Protecting Privacy and Data During Live Instruction

Live meeting sessions for this class, when applicable, are being conducted over Zoom. As the host, the instructor may be recording live sessions. Only the host has the ability to record meetings, no recording by other means is permitted. Recorded sessions will be posted in the Videos area of this class unless otherwise notified. Due to privacy, recordings are not available for download and are only accessible via Canvas for the duration of the class. If you have privacy concerns and do not wish to appear in the recording, do not turn on your video and/or audio. If you also prefer to use a pseudonym instead of your name, please let the instructor know what name you will be using so that the instructor knows who you are during the session. To rename yourself during a Zoom meeting, click on Participants, click on your name, click on More, click on Rename. If you would like to ask a question, you may do so privately through the Zoom chat by addressing your chat question to the instructor only (and not to ""everyone""). Additionally, chat may be used and moderated for live questions, and saving of chats is enabled. If you have questions or concerns about this, please contact the instructor via Canvas Inbox.

Pursuant to the terms of the agreement between Zoom and UCLA Extension, the data is used solely for this purpose and Zoom is prohibited from re-disclosing this information. UCLA Extension also does not use the data for any other purpose. Recordings will be deleted when no longer necessary. However, recordings may become part of an administrative disciplinary record if misconduct occurs during a video conference.

Course and Instructor Evaluation

UCLA Extension values your feedback on course and instructor evaluations. We ask all students to take a few minutes to complete an end-of-course evaluation survey. Updates to the course and instruction are influenced by your feedback. Understanding your student experience is essential to ensure continuing excellence in the online classroom and is appreciated by your instructor and the UCLA Extension academic leadership.

Your participation in a survey is voluntary, and your responses are confidential. After instructors submit grades, they will be given an evaluation report, but this report will not contain your name.

About Your Online Course Materials

Please note the following about online course components at UCLA Extension:

- Students must have basic computer skills, including the use of word processing software, email, and the ability to use internet browsers, such as Safari, Firefox, or Chrome.
- Students are responsible for meeting the technical requirements of Canvas and familiarizing themselves with the Canvas Learning Management System.
  - What are the browser and computer requirements for Canvas? (https://community.canvaslms.com/t5/Canvas-Basics-Guide/What-are-the-browser-and-computer-requirements-for-Instructure/ta-p/66)
- Students are responsible for keeping a copy of all assignments and work submitted, and to be aware of all assignments, due dates, and course guidelines.
- Students have access to courses via Canvas for an additional 30 calendar days after the course end date listed in the syllabus (the first 14 days are full access; the rest are read-only).
- Students are encouraged to download/print content throughout the duration of the course and before the additional 30-day access ends. No further access is possible after the course becomes unavailable.

  To download all your assignment submissions in Canvas, please refer to the online support guide. (https://community.canvaslms.com/docs/DOC-10606) for more information or contact Canvas Support via the help menu within Canvas.

UCLA Extension Canvas and Learning Support

For immediate 24/7 Canvas technical support, including holidays, click on **Help** (located on the menu to the left) where you can call or chat live with a Canvas Support representative.

UCLA Extension Academic Technology and Learning Innovation
The UCLA Extension Learning Support staff assists both students and instructors with Canvas-related technical support, as well as general and administrative questions.

Learning Support staff is available Monday through Friday, from 8 AM to 9 PM (Pacific Time), except holidays:

- Email: atli@uclaextension.edu (mailto:atli@uclaextension.edu)

Campus Safety Escorts

For students taking classes held on the UCLA campus and in and around Westwood Village, the UCLA Police Department provides a free walking escort service every day of the year from dusk until 1 a.m. Community Service Officers (CSOs) are available to walk students, faculty, staff members and visitors to and from anywhere on campus, in Westwood Village, and in the village apartments. CSOs are uniformed students who have received special training and are employed by the UCLA Police

Department. To obtain an escort, please call (310) 794-9255 and allow 15 to 20 minutes for your escort to arrive. For complete information, see UCLA Evening Escorts (https://police.ucla.edu/cso/evening-escorts).

Schedule

Date/Topic	Topics	Assignments
Week One Apr 01 - Apr 07	• Introduction and course Overview • Are you a Project manager or a Leader? • The Challenges of Leading Projects • Organizational Culture	Participate in discussion forum Complete the readings/watch the videos - posted in week one module in our online classroom.
Week Two Apr 08 - Apr 14	• Leadership begins with you or Wherever you Go, there you are • Define yourself as a leader	Participate in discussion forum Complete the readings/watch the videos - posted in week two module in our online classroom
Week Three Apr 15 - Apr 21	• Know Your Stakeholders • Communications Should be planned	Participate in discussion forum Complete the readings/watch the videos - posted in week three module in our online classroom Prepare your Organizational Culture group presentation

Week Four Apr 22 - Apr 28	• Conflict is not a Dirty Word	Participate in discussion forum Complete the readings/watch the videos - posted in week four module in our online classroom This week your short paper on organizational culture is due.
Week Five Apr 29 - May 05	• Motivation: What drives your team may not drive you and vice versa • Some thoughts about teams	Participate in discussion forum Complete the readings/watch the videos - posted in week five module in our online classroom Study for the midterm
Week Six May 06 - May 12	• Group presentations: Organizational Culture • The Project manager as Negotiator • Midterm	Take the midterm Participate in discussion forum Complete the readings/watch the videos - posted in week six module in our online classroom
Week Seven May 13 - May 19	• Leadership Styles • Emotional Intelligence	Participate in discussion forum Complete the readings/watch the videos - posted in week seven module in our online classroom

Week Eight May 20 - May 26	• Stress Management • Ethics: It's part of the job	Participate in discussion forum Complete the readings/watch the videos - posted in week eight module in our online classroom
Week Nine May 27 - Jun 02	• Politics – The Project Manager as politician	Participate in discussion forum Complete the readings/watch the videos - posted in week nine module in our online classroom
Week Ten Jun 03 - Jun 09	• Leading your team through dysfunction and other leadership challenges	Participate in discussion forum Complete the readings/watch the videos - posted in week ten module in our online classroom Prepare for your group presentation Study for the final
Week Eleven Jun 10 - Jun 16	• Short paper - Analysis of a leader • Final Thoughts and Lessons Learned • Final Exam	Take the final Celebrate!